

Deep Research Agent - Sample Report

Which Pokémon Should Receive Your Golden Bottle Cap?

Introduction

The Gold Bottle Cap is one of the most valuable items in the modern Pokémon core series games, offering a way to instantly perfect a Pokémon's Individual Values (IVs) through Hyper Training. Because Gold Bottle Caps are rare and often difficult to acquire, deciding which Pokémon deserves this investment is an important strategic question. This report synthesizes the mechanics of Hyper Training, the stat-based considerations for different battle roles, and the practical constraints on which Pokémon can or should receive this treatment, in order to provide a framework for making that decision.

Understanding Bottle Caps and Hyper Training

In the core series games, a regular Bottle Cap (also known as a Silver Bottle Cap) can be traded to maximize just one of a Pokémon's IV stats through Hyper Training ([Bulbapedia](#), [Pokémon GO Hub](#)). The Gold Bottle Cap, introduced in Generation VII, is a more valuable upgrade that maximizes all six of a Pokémon's IV stats simultaneously—HP, Attack, Defense, Special Attack, Special Defense, and Speed ([Bulbapedia](#), [Bulbapedia](#), [GamesLearningSociety](#), [Eurogamer](#)). IVs themselves range from 0 to 31 in each stat and, alongside base stats, nature, and EVs, directly determine a Pokémon's final stats ([Bulbapedia](#), [PokemonLore](#)).

There are some important limitations to keep in mind. In Pokémon Scarlet and Violet specifically, a Gold Bottle Cap cannot be used on Shadow Pokémon, nor can it be applied to a Pokémon that already has all six IVs at maximum ([GamesLearningSociety](#), [Bulbapedia](#), [Bulbapedia](#)). Because Gold Bottle Caps are rare in Scarlet and Violet—obtainable primarily through Max Raid Battles or occasional availability at the Porto Marinada Auction House, or by feeding three regular Bottle Caps plus an additional item into the Cram-o-matic—players should treat each one as a scarce resource to be allocated carefully ([GamesLearningSociety](#), [Game8](#), [Bulbapedia](#), [Reddit](#)).

Matching IVs to Battle Role

Rather than pursuing perfect IVs across the board for every Pokémon, training priorities should be determined by the Pokémon's intended battle role ([PokemonLore](#), [CBB](#)). This is precisely where the Gold Bottle Cap's blanket approach becomes especially useful: it saves the trouble of individually optimizing six separate stats and guarantees an all-around ceiling, which is valuable for Pokémon that need to perform multiple functions or where every stat matters.

Physical attackers benefit most from perfect IVs in Attack and Speed, since these stats determine damage output and turn-order control ([PokemonLore](#), [TheplayCheck](#)). Special attackers similarly rely on Special Attack and Speed IVs to maximize damage and competitive performance ([TheplayCheck](#), [Cobble-Hub](#)). Defensive "wall" Pokémon, by contrast, gain the most value from perfect IVs in HP, Defense, and Special Defense, which maximize durability and the ability to tank hits ([TheplayCheck](#), [PokemonLore](#)). Speed in particular is one of the most important tiebreakers in competitive battles, since it often determines who moves first ([PokemonLore](#), [CyberPost](#)). Even small IV differences matter: a few IV points in the right stats can be the difference between surviving a key hit or landing a necessary KO ([PokemonLore](#), [WalDev](#)). Given that a Gold Bottle Cap perfects every relevant stat at once, it is best reserved for Pokémon whose role demands strength across multiple stat categories, or for Pokémon where the player cannot otherwise easily fix imperfect IVs.

Pokémon That Especially Need Gold Bottle Caps

Certain categories of Pokémon are particularly good candidates for Gold Bottle Cap use because their IVs cannot be improved through conventional breeding. Legendary and Mythical Pokémon (with the exception of Manaphy and Phione) cannot breed in the core series games, meaning breeding-based IV improvement is simply not an option for them ([Bulbapedia](#), [Serebii](#)). Static encounter legendary Pokémon, including the box legends of recent generations, also come with fixed IVs from the encounter itself ([Reddit](#), [Bulbapedia](#)). This makes them prime candidates for Hyper Training, since a Gold Bottle Cap is often the only way to bring their IVs up to competitive standards.

Similarly, event distribution Pokémon are frequently received with fixed stats, including fixed IVs, and typically cannot be bred—especially if they are Legendary or Mythical ([Bulbapedia](#), [Bulbapedia](#), [TheGamer](#)). In-game trade Pokémon present a related case: from HeartGold and SoulSilver onward, such trades may come with fixed Nature, Trainer ID, held item, level, and IVs ([Bulbapedia](#), [PokemonLP Fandom](#)). In Pokémon Sword and Shield specifically, base-game in-game trades cannot be Shiny and have set Nature and gender, making them poor candidates for competitive use unless Hyper Training is applied to fix their IVs ([Smogon](#), [Reddit](#), [RPG Site](#), [TheGamer](#)). In all of these cases, a Gold Bottle Cap effectively "rescues" an otherwise strong Pokémon whose IVs are locked by how it was obtained.

Competitive Context: Top Restricted Legendaries

For players competing in formats like VGC, allocating a rare Gold Bottle Cap to a top-tier restricted legendary is often a natural choice, since these Pokémon anchor competitive teams and cannot be improved via breeding. Current top-tier restricted legendaries in VGC include Miraidon, Koraidon, Kyogre, Lunala, Raging Bolt, and Zamazenta-Crowned ([VGC Trainer](#), [PokeStats](#)). Investing a Gold Bottle Cap in one of these Pokémon ensures that its full stat potential is realized across all six IVs, which is especially important given that these Pokémon frequently serve dual offensive and defensive roles at the highest levels of play.

Conclusion

Deciding which Pokémon should receive a Gold Bottle Cap comes down to weighing scarcity against necessity. Because Gold Bottle Caps are rare and their all-stat-maximizing effect is powerful but limited by restrictions (they cannot be used on Shadow Pokémon or on Pokémon already at 31 IVs across all stats), they are best directed toward Pokémon whose IVs cannot be fixed through ordinary breeding—legendaries, event Pokémon, static encounters, and in-game trades—or toward competitively vital Pokémon, such as top-tier VGC restricted legendaries, whose role demands strength across multiple stats simultaneously. For Pokémon that can be freely bred, a more targeted regular Bottle Cap or conventional breeding may be sufficient, preserving the rarer Gold Bottle Cap for the Pokémon that truly need it.

Lower-Confidence Findings (Not Independently Corroborated)

The following claims appeared during research but could not be independently verified above our confidence threshold. Included for transparency, not asserted as established fact:

- Perfect Speed IVs are valuable for both physical and special attackers regardless of their primary role. (confidence: 0.40 — Could not independently corroborate. No search results were available to check for corroboration. A search error returned no results, so there are no independent sources from different domains to verify the claim about Perfect Speed IVs being valuable for both physical and special attackers. Without any search results, corroboration cannot be established.)
- In-game trade Pokémon have fixed IVs that are determined by the game. (confidence: 0.40 — Could not independently corroborate. No search results were available to check. Without any independent search results from different sources, it is impossible to corroborate the claim about in-game trade Pokémon having fixed IVs determined by the game, even though the original source (Bulbapedia) may contain this information.)
- Static encounter legendary Pokémon's fixed IVs cannot be changed except through Hyper Training with Bottle Caps. (confidence: 0.40 — Could not independently corroborate. No search results were returned (search error), so there are no alternative sources available to corroborate the claim. Without independent search results from different sources, corroboration cannot be established.)
- In-game trades in Pokémon Sword and Shield base game have static IVs of 15 in each stat. (confidence: 0.40 — Could not independently corroborate. None of the search results provide independent corroboration of the specific claim about in-game trades having static IVs of 15 in each stat in Pokémon Sword and Shield. The results are either about unrelated topics (Max Mushrooms farming, Gigantamax forms, weather mechanics, game emulation) or general Pokédex information. While serebii.net and pokemondb.net are credible Pokémon information sources different from Smogon, neither of these results specifically addresses the IV values of traded Pokémon. The results do not contain information that directly supports or discusses the claim about trade IVs.)
- In-game trades in Pokémon Sword and Shield base game come with fixed nicknames. (confidence: 0.40 — Could not independently corroborate. No search results were returned to evaluate. Without any independent sources available to review, corroboration cannot be established. The search error indicates no results were found, so there is no different source material available to support or contradict the claim about fixed nicknames in in-game trades in Pokémon Sword and Shield.)
- In Pokémon Scarlet and Violet, Gold Bottle Caps can be obtained through winning battles at the Battle Tower (exchangeable for 25 Battle Points) (confidence: 0.40 — Could not independently corroborate. None of the search results from different sources (Eurogamer, Game8, Sportskeeda, IGN) specifically mention obtaining Gold Bottle Caps through the Battle Tower or by exchanging Battle Points. The results consistently mention Porto Marinada auctions, Max Raid Battles, and ranked battles as methods to obtain Gold Bottle Caps, but there is no specific corroboration of the "25 Battle Points" exchange at the Battle Tower claim. The first result is from the same original source and therefore does not count as corroboration.)
- In Pokémon Scarlet and Violet, Gold Bottle Caps can be obtained through Ranked Battle rewards (confidence: 0.40 — Could not independently corroborate. None of the search results specifically support the claim that Gold Bottle Caps can be obtained through Ranked Battle rewards. The TikTok result mentions a "free gold bottle cap" but doesn't specify the source as Ranked Battles. The Game8 result is about Zacian movesets for Ranked Battles, not about obtaining Gold Bottle Caps. The YouTube and Serebii results are unrelated to the claim. The last result is from the same original source (gamelearningsociety.org), so it doesn't count as independent corroboration. No genuinely independent source specifically confirms the Ranked Battle rewards claim.)
- In Pokémon Scarlet and Violet, a Gold Bottle Cap can only be used on Pokémon that are Good Buddies or higher (confidence: 0.40 — Could not independently corroborate. No search results were returned that could corroborate the claim. Without any independent sources available to verify the specific claim about Gold Bottle Cap usage requirements in Pokémon Scarlet and Violet, corroboration cannot be established.)
- In Pokémon Scarlet and Violet, regular Bottle Caps only increase a single stat (confidence: 0.40 — Could not independently corroborate. No search results were returned (search error - no results available). Without any independent sources to verify against, the claim cannot be corroborated. The absence of results means no different source could confirm or specifically support the statement about regular Bottle Caps only increasing a single stat in Pokémon Scarlet and Violet.)
- VGC Regulation I is a restricted format allowing up to two restricted legendary Pokémon (confidence: 0.40 — Could not independently corroborate. No search results were returned for this claim. Without any independent sources providing search results, it is impossible to find corroboration from a different source than the original

- vgctrainer.com/guide. A search error preventing result retrieval means the claim cannot be corroborated.)
- Searches for competitive Pokémon Golden Bottle Cap strategies returned primarily Pokémon GO-related content rather than core series competitive information (confidence: 0.10 — No sources provided.)
 - No corroborable information from independent web sources is available regarding which specific Pokémon are recommended for Golden Bottle Cap usage in competitive formats like VGC or Smogon singles (confidence: 0.10 — No sources provided.)